

Zara and the Tiny Ladybird

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Zara was a small girl, six years old.
She loved playing in the garden.
One morning, she saw a ladybird.
It was tiny and red with black dots.
It crawled on a green leaf.
Zara felt excited.
She wanted to pick it up.
She reached out fast.
The ladybird tumbled off the leaf.
Zara felt worried.
Her heart beat fast.
"Did I hurt it?" she whispered.
Her grandma knelt beside her.

She said, "I see you feel worried."

Zara nodded.



"It is okay to feel worried," Grandma said.

"It shows you care."

Grandma showed her how.

"Gentle hands keep little friends safe."

"Gentle hands keep little friends safe," she said again.

"Gentle hands keep little friends safe," she said one more time.

Zara held out her hand flat.

Very still.

Very soft.

The ladybird crawled onto her finger.

Tickle, tickle.

Zara giggled quietly.

"It tickles!" she whispered.

She watched the tiny legs.

She watched the shiny wings.



"You are so small," she said.

"And so brave."

She lowered her hand to a flower.

The ladybird crawled off.

It waved its wings.

Then it flew away.

"Bye, little friend," Zara said.

She felt happy.

She had been gentle.

Being gentle felt good.

That afternoon, Zara was gentle with everything.

She stroked the cat softly.

She watered the flowers carefully.

She spoke in a quiet voice.

Grandma smiled.

"You have gentle hands and a gentle heart," she said.



At bedtime, Zara snuggled under her blanket.

She thought about the ladybird.

Flying somewhere in the night.

She felt worried earlier.

Now she felt peaceful.

The garden crickets sang softly.

Chirp, chirp, hush.

Zara closed her eyes.

She was gentle.

She was loved.

Goodnight, Zara.

Moral: Gentle hands and a gentle heart keep small
creatures safe.

The End